PKMS Competitive Audit

Executive brief · Logseq OG · Logseq 2.0 DB · Tine · TyLog

BLUF

The market has split between a frozen files-first incumbent, an ambitious but lock-in-prone database rewrite, and a fast but fragile solo rewrite. **None occupies TyLog's ground:** typed, compilable plaintext; native publishable PDF; and release-grade Android sync safety. TyLog should win as the trustworthy exit for file-owning users — not imitate Logseq's outliner depth.

Logseq OG

Mature, frozen

Files are the source of truth and the feature set is broad: queries, plugins, whiteboards, SRS, PDF annotation. But maintenance is security-only, large graphs and mobile remain rough, and sync is effectively single-writer. **Fine to stay; a dead end to invest in.**

Logseq 2.0 DB

Powerful, early

Best data model: typed properties, classes, views, incremental search, RTC/E2EE foundations. The cost is structural lock-in: SQLite source of truth, one-way desktop Markdown Mirror, lossy export, feature regressions, and an ecosystem reset. **The future of Logseq; trust is not yet earned.**

Tine

Fast, fragile

Rust-first speed, byte-compatible Logseq files, native PDF annotation, and zero migration make the bet reversible. It is also two months old, solo-maintained, without Logseq plugin compatibility, graph view, SRS, iOS, or its own sync. **Strong demand signal; too young to depend on.**

TyLog

Distinct, incomplete

Only product here whose notes are readable text, structured data, and compilable typesetting programs. It also leads on tasks, Android reliability, and conflict-safe WebDAV. Gaps: no block transclusion, query language, plugins, PDF annotation, or E2EE. **A differentiated product, not a Logseq clone.**

TyLog's defendable position

"Your notes are a typeset document, not a database."

This is the only non-replicated moat in the 16-row matrix. Tine validates demand for fast files-first tools; TyLog adds compile-checked structure, publishing, and safer mobile operation.

Strongest current claims

- Native Typst → publishable PDF
- RRULE tasks, reminders, time tracking
- Release-grade Android + ETag conflict safety
- Logseq and Obsidian import already shipped

What to do next

1. **Ship the Logseq DB importer** — The plan and import boundary already exist; serve stranded OG users and lock-in-wary DB users.
2. **Lead with the Typst/PDF moat** — Make the unique value proposition explicit in every public surface.
3. **Add query-lite** — Extend report blocks with inline dynamic sections; do not build a general query language.
4. **Add PDF annotation** — The largest missing feature for the existing reading and article workflow.
5. **Offer optional E2EE** — An age-encrypted WebDAV layer closes the main sync axis where Logseq DB leads.

Evidence: 16 × 4 matrix, 12/12 adversarial claim checks confirmed, 0 contradictions. Deliberately defer block-level refs and SRS until real demand.

Full matrix, implementation analysis, and citations: `docs/audit-pkms-comparison.pdf`